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Last week: **DJIA** 47147.48 ▲ 160.38 0.34% **NASDAQ** 22900.59 ▼ 0.5% **STOXX 600** 574.81 ▲ 1.8% **10-YR. TREASURY** (New Issue) yield 4.147% **OIL** \$60.09 ▲ \$0.34 **EURO** \$1.1621 **YEN** 154.55

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The bond market** is on pace for its strongest year since 2020, returning 6.7% in one widely tracked index, as the Fed pursues lower interest rates and inflation pressure continues to moderate. **A1**

◆ **Tesla is requiring** its suppliers to exclude Chinese-made components in the manufacturing of its electric cars in the U.S., a fresh example of the fallout from U.S.-China trade tensions. **B1**

◆ **The very rich** are taking advantage of an ecosystem of members-only services to gain an extraordinary degree of privacy and insulate themselves from inconveniences such as waiting in traffic or in line. **A1**

◆ **As tactics of mass layoffs** shift to the use of text messages and emails, with the goal of minimizing public confrontations, employers are still often committing snafus in the process. **B1**

◆ **An Estonian city** near the Russian border will be crucial in Europe's push to secure a foothold in the global rare-earth metals supply chain dominated by China. **B1**

◆ **The blast that killed 16 workers** at a Tennessee explosives plant last month has put a spotlight on safety-regulation gaps in the industry. **B9**

◆ **Generative AI** has new fans in small businesses that employ the technology to schedule worker shifts, provide price quotes and do customer service and other work. **B1**

◆ **Meta is on a pop-up store spree**, adding a New York outlet to existing locations in Las Vegas and Los Angeles as it pushes to stir demand for its Ray-Ban AI glasses. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump threw in the towel** on dissuading House Republicans from backing a measure to release files related to Epstein, saying that GOP lawmakers should instead embrace the vote. **A1**

◆ **A new nuclear arms race** involves the U.S., Russia and China, with Beijing catching up fast and Moscow developing a variety of new-generation systems. **A1**

◆ **The FAA is lifting** flight restrictions related to the shutdown, clearing the way for normal airport operations. **A3**

◆ **The Trump immigration crackdown** reached Charlotte, N.C., where federal agents made 81 arrests and local leaders denounced the move. **A3**

◆ **The White House is studying** proposals on the affordability issue, including direct payments to Americans and tariff reductions, in response to GOP election losses. **A4**

◆ **Hard-line rightist parties** showed strength in the first round of Chile's presidential election, which put a pro-Trump candidate in position to win next month's runoff. **A7**

◆ **A coalition of countries** that has long supported U.S. antidrug efforts is fraying over America's boat strikes that are being denounced as violations of international law. **A7**

◆ **Trump said the U.S.** may hold talks with Venezuela's Maduro regime as the American military buildup near that country increases. **A7**

◆ **Adriana Kugler's** departure as a Federal reserve governor came after she disclosed stock transactions that violated central bank policies. **A2**

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Election Positions Chile for a Move Toward Trump



MARVIN RECINO/APGETTY IMAGES

A LA DERECHA: Chileans rallied behind hard-line conservatives in elections Sunday amid anger over crime and immigration. Above, supporters of conservative candidate José Antonio Kast, who finished second to earn a spot in a runoff vote. **A7**

The Bond Market Is Headed For Its Best Year Since 2020

Slow jobs growth, consumer spending raise hopes for further Fed rate cuts

By KRISTAL HUR AND SAM GOLDFARB

Almost everything has lined up for bonds lately. The Federal Reserve has been cutting interest rates. Jobs growth and consumer spending are slowing, keeping hopes for further cuts alive but not pointing to an imminent recession that would

threaten corporate balance sheets. Inflation pressure has continued to moderate, despite fears that President Trump's tariffs will drive prices higher.

The widely tracked Bloomberg U.S. Aggregate Bond Index has returned around 6.7% in 2025, accounting for price changes and interest payments. That puts it on pace for the best year since 2020.

Bonds had regained ground after the Fed's inflation-fighting campaign fueled a historically bad 2022. The Bloomberg Agg—made up largely of Trea-

surys, investment-grade corporate bonds and agency mortgage-backed securities—returned 5.5% in 2023, though it almost stalled in 2024.

Investors said 2025 feels different. The climb has rewarded investors still stinging from the unusual volatility that followed the Covid-19-era inflation surge. Unlike in the previous few years, the index's returns have easily outpaced those of short-term T-bills—the other main choice for investors seeking a safe alternative to stocks.

"It's certainly been more fun to go to client meetings

this year as a bond manager," said Cal Spranger, a fixed-income manager at Badgley Phelps Wealth Managers. "A few years ago, I wasn't getting invited to any."

While yields on government and corporate bonds have gradually come down, they are still far above the paltry levels seen during much of the past decade—and investors want to lock them in while they can.

At times earlier this year, brief but sharp selloffs in U.S. Treasuries sparked alarm that the bond market might finally be buckling under the pres-

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In Shift, President Supports Epstein Disclosure

Trump tells House Republicans to vote for file release after he faced defections

WASHINGTON—President Trump threw in the towel on dissuading House Republicans from backing a measure to release files related to sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, saying Sunday night that GOP lawmakers should instead embrace the vote.

By Alex Leary, Scott Patterson and Siobhan Hughes

The vote set for this week had been shaping up as a major test of GOP loyalty to the president, who has kept an iron grip over the party since starting his second term in January. Dozens of Republicans were expected to potentially break with the president when the measure hit the House floor, and Trump's announcement Sunday night avoids a potential embarrassment for the White House.

"House Republicans should vote to release the Epstein files, because we have nothing to hide, and it's time to move on from this Democrat Hoax," Trump wrote on social media, calling it a distraction from Republican successes.

It was a sharp reversal for Trump, who had sought for months to deter Republicans from supporting the measure. But a last-minute push wasn't getting results, officials said, and risked calling even more attention to the matter as Trump seeks to calm voter anxiety over the cost of living. Some thought in hindsight it would have been best to sup-

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◆ **White House grasps for ways to lower prices..... A4**

Nuclear Race Now Matches U.S., China And Russia

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

The new nuclear race has begun. But unlike during the Cold War, the U.S. must prepare for two peer rivals rather than one—as it has lost its clear industrial and economic edge.

China, which long possessed just a small nuclear force, is catching up fast, while Russia is developing a variety of new-generation systems aimed at American cities.

Russian President Vladimir Putin has used nuclear saber-rattling to throttle U.S. support for Ukraine. He has deployed nuclear weapons to Belarus and, in recent weeks, tested a nuclear-powered missile and a nuclear-powered submarine drone he claims are impervious to U.S. defenses.

While Russia and the U.S. are still abiding by some arms-controls limits, such as the New Start treaty that expires in February, China is quietly but rapidly leaping ahead. According to U.S. estimates, Beijing will reach rough parity with the U.S. in deployed nuclear warheads by the mid-2030s.

Chinese leader Xi Jinping for the first time showcased China's nuclear triad—its land, sea and air-launched ballistic nuclear missiles—at a Beijing parade honoring the 80th anniversary of victory over Japan in September. Putin, sitting to his right atop the Gate of Heavenly Peace, took

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INSIDE



MADDIE MCGARVEY FOR WSJ

U.S. NEWS

Fallout from an immigration raid at a taco shop splits a town in Ohio. **A3**



ANNIE RICE FOR WSJ

SPORTS

The Texas billionaire who is trying to tame the wild west of college sports. **A14**

The Beloved Ladybug Is Having A Publicity Crisis

* * *

Once known for bringing luck, the insect now gets a bad rap thanks to an invasive species

By OWEN TUCKER-SMITH

They crept into his home en masse, climbing through the air-conditioning units, clinging to the window curtains, marching down the wall, trotting across the vaulted ceiling, lurking in the gloom of the basement. Jon Nixon had never seen so many ladybugs in his life.

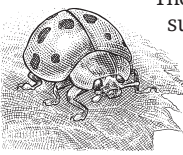
The 35-year-old was taught these were friendly creatures. "You rub their shell for good luck," he said. But by the time his house in central Maine was host to hundreds

of them this fall, Nixon was fed up. This was, he said, "too many ladybugs." Even for a fan.

"It stopped feeling like good luck, and started feeling like a nuisance."

The ladybug, once a treasured member of the animal kingdom, is six legs deep in a publicity crisis. The harlequin lady beetle, an invasive species of the bug infamous for its habit of burrowing in homes each fall, has proliferated in the U.S. over the past few decades,

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Fly away home

This City Is No. 1 In Legal Homicides

Authorities in Jacksonville label cases self-defense; not reflected in murder stats

JACKSONVILLE, Fla.—LaToya Williams chased the sound of gunshots from the house to a dirt road where her

By Hannah Critchfield, Paul Overberg and Mark Maremont

16-year-old son had fallen from a bullet through the ribs.

Can you call 911? the teenager said. *It's bad, Mom.*

Police arrived, and paramedics lifted Khalian Fedrick

into an ambulance. Williams begged to ride with her son to the hospital but was told she couldn't.

Williams, who didn't have a car, asked police for a ride, but no officer volunteered. She set out on the 13-minute walk to the emergency room of UF Health Jacksonville, the hospital where she had given birth to her son.

While Fedrick was in surgery, Williams spoke with Sgt.

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The Ultrarich Pay Big For Extreme Privacy

By ARIAN CAMPO-FLORES

When developers Masoud and Stephanie Shojaei dined out recently, they headed to the members-only section of MILA restaurant in Miami Beach, Fla., where they were whisked to a table already bearing their favorite cocktails and chopsticks engraved with their names.

On a business trip to Dubai last month, the Shojaeis exited their Bombardier Global jet and later stepped into a waiting Maybach that zipped them to a lavish hotel. They went through a private entrance that bypassed the lobby and took an elevator straight up to the Royal Suite, where a staffer checked them in and presented their butler.

"For me, luxury in this era is defined as time-saving and efficiency and service," said Masoud Shojaei, the 65-year-old chief executive of Shoma Group, a residential and commercial developer.

The ultrawealthy are wielding their growing fortunes to glide through a rarefied realm unencumbered by the inconveniences of ordinary life. They don't wait in lines. They don't jostle with airport crowds or idle unnecessarily in traffic.

Instead, an ecosystem of exclusive restaurants, clubs, resorts and other service providers delivers them customized and exquisite experiences as fast as possible. The spaces they inhabit are often private, carefully curated and popu-

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